Russia's strategic partnership with China has strengthened in recent years,[125] and India is thus the only larger power that could potentially serve as a counter-weight to China's ambitions and enhanced influence on the Eurasian landmass. India's threat to Chinese interests in the region would grow if India entered into a closer military cooperation with the United States, enabling a larger US forward posture in the Indian Ocean Region. Hence, it should not be in Beijing's interests to force New Delhi into an alliance with Washington.

Beijing is, of course, aware of states' tendency to balance against power, and with the power gap vis-à-vis India growing, the likelihood of India balancing China is also higher. If reassuring India proved difficult for China in the late 1990s and early 2000s, it is not any easier today. A wedge strategy means that China actively attempts to prevent India from entering into an alliance with the United States through either selective accommodation, confrontation, or a combination of both. China maintains its stance on the border issue, it continues its policy of proxy balancing through Pakistan (and increasingly so also through other countries), and the PLA Navy now sails in the Indian Ocean. Regardless of Beijing's true intentions, the totality of these developments is a signal from China that it can hurt Indian interests if it wants to, which fits with the confrontative part of a wedge strategy. However, in recent years, Beijing has also given some signals of selective accommodation vis-à-vis India.

Since Xi Jinping took the reins in Beijing and his first visit to India in 2014, China has looked at consolidating a closer relationship with India and strengthening their economic cooperation, and Chinese efforts have been strengthened after the Doklam standoff.[126] As a response to India complaining about its growing trade deficit with China, Beijing in 2016 set up a new trade body to promote and coordinate Chinese investments and businesses with